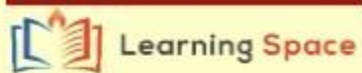


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NEWSPAPER

3rd August, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

31st WEEK



VENEZUELA ... ON DIFFICULT TERRAIN

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS.



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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

3rd AUGUST, 2017

3

Contested polls

Elections to a new Constituent Assembly
in Venezuela lack legitimacy

After months of political protests and government crackdowns, Venezuela held elections to a new Constituent Assembly to rewrite the Constitution. President Nicolás Maduro claims the new assembly was required to calm the unrest that has beset Venezuela amid an economic contraction and runaway inflation. But the opposition boycotted the polls to the assembly, which it says is being convened to overhaul the powers of the elected National Assembly where the opposition parties enjoy a two-thirds majority after electoral victories in December 2015. The Constituent Assembly was announced by decree by the government. It said that nearly 41.5% of the registered electorate voted in the polls, a figure the opposition contests. The need for a Constituent Assembly to address the crisis seems unclear. Venezuela had last elected one in 1999 following a referendum during former President Hugo Chávez's first term. That vote had overwhelmingly backed a new Constituent Assembly to enable the transition of Venezuela's political system from the Fourth Republic to the Bolivarian Republic. The creation of the Bolivarian Republic was claimed to be a decisive step away from *Puntofijismo*, a pact among dominant political parties to install a formal liberal democratic order that limited political competition and was seen to rig economic policy in favour of the elite.

Among the outcomes of the constitution-writing process in 1999 were an extension of the term limit of the presidency, assured representation for marginalised indigenous groups in the National Assembly and conversion of the bicameral legislature into a unicameral body. President Chávez's redistributionist economic agenda relied heavily on the income generated by the nationalised petroleum industry. In the boom years, this may have lifted some sections of Venezuelans from poverty and provided a measure of education and health care, helping the ruling United Socialist Party of Venezuela (PSUV) consolidate its hold on power. However, the spree of reckless spending and a failure to diversify the economy resulted in a severe economic

THE  HINDU

Date : 3rd August, 2017



UNITED STATES

North
Atlantic
Ocean

MEXICO

Gulf of Mexico

NORTH
PACIFIC
OCEAN

Caribbean Sea

VENEZUELA

COLOMBIA

ECUADOR

PERU

BRAZIL

BOLIVIA

SOUTH
PACIFIC
OCEAN

SOUTH
ATLANTIC
OCEAN

SPAIN

MOROCCO

MAURITANI



VENEZUELA ... SINCE 2000



1 The transition of Venezuela's political system took place in 1999, when the political system was changed from the Fourth Republic to Bolivarian Republic.

2 That assured representation for marginalized indigenous groups in the National Assembly and conversion of the bicameral legislature into a unicameral body. Subsequently, redistributionist economic agenda relied heavily on the income generated by the nationalized petroleum industry.

3 In the boom years, this lifted some sections of Venezuelans from poverty.

4 That also provided education and health care helping the ruling United Socialist Party of Venezuela consolidating its power.



WHAT WENT WRONG IN RECENT TIMES?



- 1 It went on with reckless spending, which started in the times of oil boom.
- 2 It failed to diversify the economy.
- 3 Once oil prices started falling, severe economic crisis erupted.
- 4 The economy contracted by a third in the past four years as per some reports.
- 5 It could not continue the social spending.
- 6 It resulted in scarcity for several products.
- 7 Support for the regime weakened.
- 8 Opposition strengthened.
- 9 The Opposition leaders were put under house arrest.



Nicolas Maduro
President, Venezuela

Mr. Maduro's attempt to consolidate power through the new Constituent Assembly lacks legitimacy and may not heal the democratic rupture.

WE EXPRESS OUR SINCERE THANKS FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

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For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

D. Sunil Kumar
V. Dayakar James
Y. Sri Poojita

G. Ravi Babu
D. Joji
K. Victor Babu

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